INTRODUCTION

Early in my tenure as the Governor of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI), Krishan Chopra of HarperCollins asked me to write a book. He suggested putting together edited versions of my past articles and speeches under different themes. I pleaded that I was extremely busy, and simply did not have the time. As my term came to an end, however, I realized time would be less of a constraint. In the speeches I gave while at the RBI, I had been describing the reforms we were undertaking and the rationale behind them, both to build confidence amongst investors and to get support from the public. If I could link the speeches together in a book with commentary about what prompted each speech, I could give the youth of the country a feel for the excitement of working at the central bank. I hoped this would attract a few into the area of economics and finance, where India really needs more good people. Moreover, if I could describe the overall rationale for what had been done, completed reforms could stand a better chance of not being reversed, while incomplete reforms could be finished.

I did not want to intrude on my successor's initial engagement with the public, so I determined to stay silent on India for a year. This book will be published after that year is over. Also, while I have tried to explain my rationale for various speeches and actions through linking commentary, I have respected the privacy of conversations I had with various public figures. I have also added a short selection of some speeches and articles that I wrote, primarily while I was the Chief